



Quora's 'Writing Sessions'

Quora to host 'Writing Sessions', a live Q&A session similar to Reddit's AMA!
<http://dgit.in/QuoraWS>



Workchat by Facebook

Facebook launches a new version of messenger for Facebook at Work called Work Chat. <http://dgit.in/FBWorkChat>



Gigato's Toll Free internet

Shailesh Nalawadi, CEO of Mavin, on how Gigato aims to spread "more internet, in more places, for more people" without violating net neutrality



◀ Shailesh Nalawadi
CEO, Mavin

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d What is Mavin and where does Gigato fit into the overall picture?

Sailesh: Mavin is the company and Gigato is our first product. The founders of the company have in some capacity or the other worked on internet related technology over the last 15 years. Our strong feeling was that wherever possible providing more internet access for more people in more places is unambiguously a good thing for society. So we started with a very high moral concept saying what can we do to spread internet access to more places and particularly in emerging markets like India where we have 130 million smartphones in circulation within the country but only 60 million 3G connections. So our goal was what can we do to spread the internet and that's why we started Mavin. After a lot of deliberations and trying few different things we decided to go to markets with a very specific product which we felt bolsters the long term vision of the company and that product is Gigato. What Gigato does is that it provides a platform which allows mobile app developers to pay for the data that their users consume. Think of this as toll-free data. We have today, the concept of toll-free

numbers right? All these 1-800 numbers which if you call you do not incur the call charges. So our concept is very similar, except that the icon of an app on your smartphone that is toll free. So you can use that without paying for any data charges whatsoever.

d How does the arrangement work between you and the app developer that comes on board Gigato?

Sailesh: They come to us and say we're interested in sponsoring certain amount of engagement. We want to reach a certain segment of our community of users, and we want to reward them up to a certain amount of engagement and how much the engagement is, depends entirely on the app. If you are a music streaming application, it comes down to the number of minutes of music. If you are a shopping application, it might come down to minutes you spend browsing or it may come to the number of pages that you view. Similarly with news applications they might say we want readers to read ten news articles or watch three news videos without incurring data charges. So that's the way our mobile apps think about it. When they come to us we take that idea and we convert it into specific megabytes that they have in mind, whether it is 10 MB

of streaming music or 15 MB of surfing on say Amazon or say 20 minutes of reading news on Times of India. And then we launch a promotion within Gigato that would say use 'x MB' of this streaming music app for free. The only thing that the app developer has to worry about is how many overall megabytes of promotion did I incur. We send them a consolidated bill that says here's all the megabytes that were consumed during our promotion via your application and that is the bill they pay. What does the consumer get? The consumer gets to use the app without worrying about data charges. If they are sitting on a bus heading home, there is a big traffic jam, they can listen to some music, maybe they can read the news or order their kathi rolls that will be waiting for them by the time they get home.

d Interesting. So you guys have tied up with the operator or network. How do you channel all that data? Is it some kind of deep packet scanning that you do to allow those data bits to transmit for free or what is the system?

Sailesh: So, just to be clear, what you are describing is zero rating – when you are looking at the packet and saying this packet is free and this packet is not free – we don't do that. All we do is on your